



(traditional water pot). The water from the well is not only sweet but also beneficial for health. Our cattle also drink this water, and our well-being has improved. If a drop of water from the tank can bring such happiness, then drinking the water from the well is like nectar for us," beams Kamshriben with happiness.

The Foundation involved farmers, community members, and gram panchayats of the villages in the project and also government departments throughout the various phases of the project cycle. A thorough study of the topography, watershed delineation and primary water-related data was gathered through experts, with the government involved in identifying water bodies and proposed project sites. A participatory rural appraisal approach, backed by triangulated baseline assessment data, was used to

implement local solutions for resolving issues pertaining to water. Local youth were trained as 'Bhujal Jankars' to collect data, and for site monitoring and management activities.

Also, the Foundation engaged with the beneficiaries and government bodies to develop and implement techniques for collection and storage of rainwater. They reached out to the communities through the 'Pani Samiti', the gram panchayat or village development committees, followed by focus group discussions and 'faliya' (hamlet) meetings with women and street plays with school kids. This created awareness about improved access to clean and safe water, reducing pollution and the effects of climate change.

The efforts have paid off. There has been an increase in water storage in stream for irrigation, boosting livelihoods post stream rejuvenation that encouraged sustainable agriculture. Promotion of micro irrigation systems, like drip irrigation, in the region impacted the overall wellbeing of the farming communities. Through rooftop rainwater harvesting and recharge borewell technique, a water source is created for use throughout the year. Villagers no longer have to travel long distances to fetch water, and potable water is now available at the doorstep. The availability of water has also ensured safety, security and the overall well-being of women and children in the area.

The initiatives and the efforts of the Foundation continue to provide sustainable solutions for the community to improve farming and ease of living.

